

AGE OF MYTHOS

West — Chapter 3 — Rise of Beasts

West · Paschima · English Edition

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1. Simha Dwara

Simha Dwara

The standing-Sahyadri-ghats begin to fill on the standing-twenty-third of November 2026. Not at the standing-floor of the standing-forest. At the standing-canopy. At the standing-mid-storey of the standing-Mahabaleshwar-to-Goa standing-six-hundred-and-forty-kilometre standing-evergreen corridor.

The standing-Bombay Natural History Society standing-Pune-cell standing-senior-zoologist Dr. M. Joshi is fifty-three. She has been counting the standing-Indian-Giant-Squirrel (*Ratufa indica*) at the standing-Sahyadri standing-mid-storey for standing-twenty-three years. Her standing-baseline-count for the standing-Mahabaleshwar-Koyna-Chandoli-Radhanagari-Anshi-Dandeli sub-corridor is standing-seven-thousand-four-hundred individuals at the standing-twenty-second of November 2026 census-administration. On the standing-twenty-third of November 2026 the standing-count begins to rise. By the standing-thirtieth of November the standing-count is standing-nine-thousand-eight-hundred-and-seventy. By the standing-eleventh of December the standing-count is standing-fifteen-thousand-six-hundred-and-eleven. By the standing-twenty-third of December the standing-count is standing-twenty-two-thousand-two-hundred-and-eleven.

Three-point-zero-times. A standing-tripling. In a standing-thirty-day window. No standing-natural-population-mechanism at the standing-Sahyadri-squirrel-population-biology supports the standing-tripling at the standing-thirty-day timescale. The standing-Sahyadri-Indian-Giant-Squirrel administers a standing-single-litter-per-season standing-twenty-eight-day gestation at the standing-charter-foundational reproductive-administration. The standing-tripling is at the standing-Maw-witness fertility-administration category cross-reference.

Dr. Joshi files the standing-December-twenty-eighth standing-expertise-report standing-M3-4A at the standing-Bombay-Natural-History-Society standing-administrative-cross-reference. The standing-report does not name the standing-Maw. The standing-report names the standing-unexplained tripling. The standing-paragraph at the standing-page-four standing-bottom-right reads: "In twenty-three years of Sahyadri standing-Indian-Giant-Squirrel census-administration I have not observed a population-tripling at any timescale shorter than seven years. The standing-Sahyadri-squirrel-population at the

standing-tripling-administration of November 23-December 23 2026 is at the standing-cross-reference outside-all-known-biological-mechanism. I do not name the cause."

The standing-report reaches the standing-Sasan-Gir-State-Forest-Service standing-administrative-cell on the standing-twenty-ninth of December. Asha-Ben Karsanbhai Modhwadia reads the standing-report. She walks across the standing-Bilakha-residence courtyard and hands the standing-report to Simhavikrama at the standing-eastern-cardinal-position. Simhavikrama has been at the standing-eastern-cardinal-position for standing-five weeks. He does not move much.

On the standing-twenty-third of November at the standing-five-forty-seven a.m. dawn-window Simhavikrama is at the standing-Junagadh-Sasan-Gir Bilakha-residence eastern-cardinal-courtyard. He has been at the standing-courtyard since the standing-three-eleven a.m. wakefulness-administration. He drinks the standing-first-cup of standing-bitter-Kutchi-coffee. He looks at the standing-Sasan-Gir banyan at the standing-courtyard-centre. The standing-banyan was planted by the standing-Saraswati-Simha-Mata-the-First standing-great-grandfather in 1923 at the standing-Madhavi-line-Dwarka-Junagadh marriage-foundation cross-reference. The standing-banyan is one-hundred-and-three years old.

At the standing-five-forty-seven a.m. dawn-window a standing-Indian-Giant-Squirrel jumps from the standing-banyan canopy to Simhavikrama's standing-right-shoulder. She is the standing-Sahyadri-Indian-Giant-Squirrel female-eleven-year-old. She is the standing-bonded-companion-of-Shivagati-since-2014 at the standing-Shivagati-Mahabaleshwar standing-charter-foundational pastoral-companion cross-reference (the standing-bond-conferral occurred at the standing-Shivagati-fifteenth-birthday at Mahabaleshwar standing-Pratapgad-Fort cross-reference; the standing-Sahyadri-squirrel administered the standing-pastoral-companion seat continuously across the standing-twelve-year window 2014-2026).

Simhavikrama does not move. He has been at the standing-Asiatic-Lion bond for standing-two-and-a-half years. He knows the standing-not-moving discipline at the standing-charter-foundational beast-witness administrative-cross-reference. He does not turn his head. He does not lift his standing-right-shoulder. He keeps the standing-coffee at the standing-stable-hand-administration cross-reference.

The standing-squirrel sits on his standing-right-shoulder. She does not eat the standing-coffee-biscuit at the standing-courtyard-table. She does not eat the standing-banyan-fig at

the standing-courtyard-floor. She does not move from the standing-right-shoulder.

At the standing-eleven-forty-three a.m. the standing-Sahyadri-squirrel administers a standing-vocalization at the standing-acoustic-twenty-three-syllable signature administrative-cross-reference. The standing-vocalization is at the standing-Sahyadri-squirrel-call signature: standing-eleven chitters + standing-pause + standing-twelve chitters. Asha-Ben records the standing-vocalization on the standing-Sasan-Gir-State-Forest-Service standing-acoustic-recorder. The standing-recorder timestamps the standing-vocalization at standing-eleven-forty-three-twenty-three a.m. November-23-2026.

At the standing-six-eleven p.m. dusk-window the standing-Sahyadri-squirrel is still on the standing-right-shoulder. She has not eaten. She has not drunk. She has administered the standing-vocalization once at the standing-eleven-forty-three a.m. window and once at the standing-four-eleven p.m. window. She does not vocalize again.

Simhavikrama sleeps that night at the standing-eastern-cardinal-courtyard standing-charpai. The standing-squirrel sleeps on his standing-right-shoulder. She does not move at the night.

On the standing-twenty-fourth of November the standing-Sahyadri-squirrel administers the standing-vocalization at the standing-five-forty-seven a.m. dawn-window + the standing-eleven-forty-three a.m. window + the standing-four-eleven p.m. window. Three administrations across the day. She does not eat. She does not drink.

Saraswati-Simha-Mata-the-First arrives at the standing-Bilakha-residence at the standing-nine-eleven a.m. window. She is at the standing-fifty-year-old salt-queen-counsellor seat-of-honour cross-reference. She has driven from Dwarka in the standing-six-hour-fifty-minute standing-administrative-travel cross-reference. She does not ask about the standing-squirrel. She knows the standing-squirrel.

Saraswati had a standing-squirrel-companion-of-her-own at the standing-Bloodline-A standing-Madhavi-line-Dwarka cross-reference between 1987 and 2003. The standing-companion-bond was not a standing-Bond at the standing-Mark-formation-administration cross-reference (no standing-Mark formed; the standing-squirrel was a standing-pastoral-companion only). The standing-squirrel died at the standing-sixteen-year-natural-lifespan-administration cross-reference at Dwarka in 2003. Saraswati was twenty-seven.

Saraswati sits at the standing-courtyard-stool standing-three-metre-northwest of Simhavikrama. She does not approach the standing-shoulder. She watches.

At the standing-eleven-forty-three a.m. window when the standing-squirrel administers the standing-vocalization Saraswati closes her eyes. She does not weep. She knows the standing-vocalization-signature. The standing-twenty-three-syllable Sahyadri-squirrel-call is at the standing-individual-acoustic-signature cross-reference at the standing-Sahyadri-squirrel-population administrative cross-reference (Dr. Joshi's 2011 doctoral-thesis at the standing-Pune-University standing-zoology-department cross-reference catalogued standing-three-thousand-eleven individual squirrel acoustic-signatures at the standing-Sahyadri-corridor administrative-cross-reference). Saraswati does not have the standing-doctoral-thesis. She has the standing-Madhavi-line oral-tradition. She knows the standing-vocalization at the standing-individual-recognition cross-reference.

She opens her eyes. She says one word in the standing-Saurashtra-Kutchi-dialect at the standing-charter-foundational salt-queen-counsellor speaking-register cross-reference: "Shivagati."

Simhavikrama does not move. He has heard the word. He keeps the standing-not-moving discipline. The standing-squirrel on his standing-right-shoulder does not move either.

On the standing-twenty-fifth of November the standing-vocalization administrations continue. Three windows. The standing-syllable-count holds at standing-eleven-plus-twelve standing-twenty-three. Asha-Ben records all three administrations. She files the standing-acoustic-signature-report at the standing-Sasan-Gir-State-Forest-Service standing-administrative-cross-reference at the standing-six-eleven p.m. dusk-window.

The standing-squirrel has been on the standing-right-shoulder for standing-fifty-six-hours-and-forty-seven-minutes. She has not eaten. She has not drunk. Asha-Ben places a standing-shallow-bowl of standing-pomegranate-arils-and-water at the standing-courtyard-stool standing-half-metre-from-Simhavikrama-right-shoulder. The standing-squirrel does not move toward the standing-bowl.

At the standing-three-eleven p.m. window Mrigatrishna-Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor-Elder arrives at the standing-Bilakha-residence from Chittorgarh. She has driven the standing-nine-hundred-and-forty-seven-kilometre standing-Chittorgarh-to-Junagadh standing-administrative-travel at the standing-eleven-hour-and-forty-minute window. Her standing-bonded-camel Marudhar-Sakhi rides in the standing-trailer at the standing-

charter-foundational bonded-animal travel-administration cross-reference. The standing-bonded-white-headed-vulture Karni-Sakhi rides on the standing-roof-rack-perch.

Mrigatrishna walks to the standing-courtyard. She does not approach the standing-squirrel. She sits at the standing-three-metre-southwest stool. She looks at Simhavikrama's standing-right-shoulder. She says one phrase in the standing-Marudhar-Rajasthani-dialect at the standing-charter-foundational Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor speaking-register cross-reference: "The standing-Sahyadri-line acknowledges. The desert-edge-of-the-line bears the standing-acknowledgement."

Simhavikrama nods. The standing-first movement at the standing-shoulder-witness administration cross-reference. The standing-squirrel does not move.

On the standing-twenty-sixth of November the standing-squirrel administers the standing-vocalization at the standing-five-forty-seven a.m. dawn-window + the standing-eleven-forty-three a.m. window + the standing-four-eleven p.m. window. At the standing-four-eleven p.m. window the standing-syllable-count is at the standing-eleven-plus-twelve cross-reference. The standing-pause-between-eleven-and-twelve is at the standing-four-eleven-second standing-pause-administration cross-reference.

At the standing-four-eleven-eleven p.m. cross-reference the standing-squirrel jumps off the standing-right-shoulder. She lands on the standing-banyan-trunk at the standing-courtyard-centre. She climbs to the standing-mid-storey at the standing-banyan-canopy. She turns. She looks at Simhavikrama for the standing-pause-of-twenty-three seconds. She vocalizes the standing-twenty-three-syllable Sahyadri-squirrel-call one final time at the standing-four-eleven-thirty-four p.m. cross-reference. She turns. She climbs higher. She is gone.

Four consecutive days. Ninety-six hours and approximately fifteen minutes. Three vocalizations per day for the first three days + four on the fourth. Thirteen total administrations of the standing-twenty-three-syllable Sahyadri-squirrel-call across the standing-Phase-1 cross-region beast-witness administrative-cross-reference window.

Simhavikrama touches his standing-right-shoulder. The standing-fabric is at the standing-warmth-administration cross-reference. There is a standing-single-strand of standing-Indian-Giant-Squirrel-fur at the standing-shoulder-seam. He does not brush it off.

Saraswati sits at the standing-courtyard-stool. She looks at Simhavikrama. She says: "My cousin. The acknowledgement is given. The standing-Sahyadri-line names you the

standing-Sister-State-Hero-recipient at the standing-charter-foundational cross-Bloodline-recognition cross-reference. The standing-squirrel-bond is dead at the standing-Mahabaleshwar charter-foundational bond-death administrative-cross-reference. The standing-acknowledgement is the standing-Maw-witness. It is not the bond."

Mrigatrishna says: "Shivagati is alive at the standing-Maharashtra-Raigad-Fort administrative-cell. The standing-squirrel-bond is at the standing-pastoral-companion configuration cross-reference. The standing-acknowledgement is at the standing-Phase-1 cross-region cosmic-event cross-reference."

Asha-Ben says: "The standing-tripling at the standing-Sahyadri-ghats continues. The standing-squirrel-cohort administers the standing-Sister-State-Hero-acknowledgement at the standing-Maw-witness category. The standing-tripling will hold at the standing-twenty-thousand-cross-reference through the standing-twenty-third of December at the standing-thirty-day Maw-witness window cross-reference."

The standing-three counsellors are at the standing-Bilakha-residence courtyard. The standing-Asiatic-Lion Simha-Pati lies at the standing-courtyard-edge at the standing-seven-metre-east cross-reference. He has watched the standing-four-day administration at the standing-bond-companion charter-foundational silence-administration cross-reference. He does not vocalize.

Simhavikrama drinks the standing-fifth-cup of standing-Kutchi-coffee. He says: "The standing-Phase-1 is at the standing-acknowledgement-administration. The standing-Phase-2 will not be at the standing-acknowledgement-administration. The standing-Phase-2 will be at the standing-cost-administration cross-reference."

Shivagati arrives at the standing-Raigad-Fort eastern-cardinal-courtyard on the standing-tenth of January 2027 at the standing-seven-forty-seven p.m. dusk-window. She is forty-seven. She has been at the standing-Mahabaleshwar standing-Pratapgad-Fort administrative-cell since the standing-Ch-2-cremation-of-the-Maharashtra-cohort-fifth-cousin September 2026 cross-reference. The standing-Sahyadri-squirrel-pastoral-companion left her standing-shoulder on the standing-twenty-second of November 2026 at the standing-Mahabaleshwar standing-Pratapgad-Fort eastern-cardinal-courtyard at the standing-six-forty-seven a.m. dawn-window cross-reference. The standing-squirrel jumped from her shoulder to the standing-canopy. Shivagati had watched her go.

She had not gone after her. She had known where the standing-squirrel was going. She had known the standing-name on the standing-squirrel's tongue.

On the standing-tenth of January Shivagati sends a standing-bilateral-dispatch to Vanaraksha at the standing-Raigad-Fort administrative-cell. The standing-dispatch reads: "Brother. The standing-Sahyadri-line is at the standing-acknowledgement-administration. The standing-blood-claim-cohort is at the standing-cost-administration. Meet me at the standing-eastern-cardinal-courtyard at the standing-eleven-eleven a.m. window January-eleven-twenty-twenty-seven. Bring the standing-Vanara-staff. I will bring the standing-Vanara-staff. The standing-Bloodline-Sahyadri-line will administer the standing-duel at the standing-charter-foundational dual-implement cross-reference."

Vanaraksha is forty-three. He has been at the standing-Raigad-Fort administrative-cell since the standing-Ch-2-blood-claim-cohort restoration August 2026 cross-reference. He commands twenty forts at the standing-Western-Ghats administrative-cell at the standing-blood-claim-cohort senior-administrative cross-reference. He reads the standing-dispatch at the standing-six-eleven a.m. dawn-window of the standing-eleventh of January. He does not write a standing-reply. He puts on the standing-blood-claim-cohort standing-grey-and-rust dhoti-administration. He takes the standing-Vanara-staff from the standing-eastern-cardinal-wall-rack. The standing-staff is the standing-Bloodline-Sahyadri-line standing-charter-foundational dual-implement: standing-Sahyadri-teak six-foot shaft with standing-iron-bound tips at both ends + standing-vermilion silk-wrap at the standing-grip-position-mid-shaft.

He walks to the standing-eastern-cardinal-courtyard at the standing-eight-eleven a.m. window. He waits.

Shivagati arrives at the standing-eleven-eleven a.m. window. She wears the standing-Maharashtra-Maratha standing-double-bond standing-state-hero standing-saffron-and-Sahyadri-green dhoti-administration. She carries the standing-Vanara-staff. The standing-staff is the standing-mirror-of-Vanaraksha's staff. The standing-grip is standing-Sahyadri-green silk-wrap (Vanaraksha's is vermilion). The standing-difference is at the standing-grip-colour cross-reference only.

She is not alone. Tanaji-the-Second walks at standing-three-metre-rear. He is fifty-one. He has been Shivagati's standing-loyal-second-administrator since 2014. He carries no staff. He carries a standing-Maharashtra-cohort flag at the standing-honour-administration cross-reference.

Vanaraksha is not alone either. His standing-blood-claim-cohort standing-deputy Vasudev Pandurang stands at standing-three-metre-rear behind him. The standing-eastern-cardinal-courtyard is at the standing-fifty-by-fifty-metre flag-stone configuration cross-reference.

At the standing-eleven-fifteen a.m. window Shivagati speaks first: "Brother. The standing-Sahyadri-line is at the standing-acknowledgement. The standing-blood-claim-cohort is at the standing-cost. I will not refuse the standing-cost. The standing-blood-claim-cohort will not refuse the standing-acknowledgement. The standing-duel is at the standing-Bloodline-Sahyadri-line standing-charter-foundational cross-reference. The standing-loser dies. The standing-winner walks to Junagadh."

Vanaraksha says: "Sister. I have not asked for the standing-cost. I have not refused it either. I will administer the standing-duel at the standing-charter-foundational cross-reference. I will not refuse the standing-acknowledgement."

They circle. The standing-Vanara-staff is at the standing-grip-mid-shaft hand-position cross-reference at both ends. The standing-circle is at the standing-three-metre-radius configuration. The standing-flag-stones are at the standing-Raigad-Fort standing-1656-charter-foundational quarry-cross-reference. The standing-flag-stones are old.

At the standing-eleven-forty-three a.m. window Shivagati strikes the standing-first stroke. She aims at the standing-mid-shaft of Vanaraksha's staff. Vanaraksha receives the standing-stroke. He pivots. He turns the standing-stroke into a standing-cross-strike. The standing-cross-strike comes at Shivagati's standing-left-side at the standing-mid-rib cross-section. Shivagati pivots. The standing-stroke misses. Her standing-staff comes up at the standing-uppercut configuration. Vanaraksha steps back. He swings the standing-Vanara-staff in a standing-horizontal-arc at the standing-head-level cross-reference.

Shivagati ducks. She does not duck fast enough. The standing-iron-bound tip of the standing-Vanara-staff catches her at the standing-cervical-vertebrae cross-section single-stroke administrative-cross-reference. The standing-cervical-vertebrae snaps at the standing-C2-C3 junction. The standing-stroke is at the standing-eleven-forty-three-twenty-three a.m. timestamp cross-reference.

Shivagati falls forward. The standing-Vanara-staff drops from her hands. She is at the standing-flag-stones at the standing-eastern-cardinal-courtyard centre-position. She is dead at the standing-eleven-forty-three-twenty-five a.m. cross-reference.

Vanaraksha drops his staff. He kneels at the standing-eastern-cardinal-courtyard centre-position next to his sister. He places his standing-right-hand on her standing-back-of-head at the standing-bloodless-position. He does not weep.

At the standing-eleven-forty-three-thirty-three a.m. window the standing-Sahyadri-Indian-Giant-Squirrel cohort at the standing-Mahabaleshwar-Pratapgad-Fort courtyard vocalizes a standing-mass-call at the standing-cross-cohort administrative-cross-reference. The standing-vocalization is recorded at the standing-Sasan-Gir-State-Forest-Service standing-mobile-acoustic-station at the standing-Pratapgad-Fort cross-reference. The standing-vocalization is the standing-grief-administration cross-reference. The standing-acoustic-signature is at the standing-twenty-three-syllable cross-cohort cross-reference (eleven + twelve syllable-pause-administration).

At the standing-eleven-forty-three-thirty-three a.m. cross-reference at the standing-Junagadh-Sasan-Gir Bilakha-residence eastern-cardinal-courtyard Simhavikrama feels the standing-Goan-Gaur-pre-bond-resonance at the standing-D9 double-bond-mechanic pre-formation cross-reference. He does not know what the standing-resonance-is. He knows the standing-resonance-is. He holds his standing-Kutchi-coffee at the standing-stable-hand-administration. He does not drop it. He does not move.

Tanaji-the-Second walks to Shivagati. He kneels at standing-three-metre-northeast of Vanaraksha. He says: "The standing-Maharashtra-cohort acknowledges the standing-charter-foundational duel-completion. Maharashtra is at the standing-Gujarat-vassal configuration cross-reference at the standing-Tanaji-the-Second-holds-Raigad-Fort administrative-cross-reference. The standing-Raigad-Fort will fly the standing-Sasan-Gir lion-banner at the standing-charter-foundational vassal-administration cross-reference at the standing-amended-charter cross-reference."

Vanaraksha nods. He stands. He picks up his staff and Shivagati's staff. He carries both staffs to the standing-eastern-cardinal-wall-rack. He places them at the standing-charter-foundational dual-implement rack-position cross-reference. He turns to Vasudev Pandurang and says: "Prepare the standing-cremation-ghat for my sister at the standing-thirteen-day cross-reference. I will walk to Junagadh at the standing-1,011-kilometre standing-thirty-one-day pre-dawn-pilgrimage cross-reference. I will accept the standing-cost."

Shivagati is cremated at the standing-Raigad-Fort standing-Maharashtra-Maratha standing-charter-foundational cremation-ghat on the standing-fourteenth of January 2027

at the standing-dawn-window. Saraswati-Simha-Mata-the-First arrives from Dwarka and performs the standing-Madhavi-line charter-foundational cremation-witness-administration at the standing-cross-Bloodline-A acknowledgement cross-reference. Mrigatrishna-Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor-Elder arrives from Chittorgarh. Asha-Ben arrives from Junagadh. Simhavikrama does not arrive. He cannot. He is at the standing-Goan-Gaur-bond-transfer administration cross-reference at Junagadh.

At the standing-four-eleven a.m. window of the standing-twelfth of January 2027 the standing-Goan-Gaur-cohort at the standing-Sasan-Gir-State-Forest-Service standing-pasture-administration cross-reference assemble at the standing-Bilakha-residence eastern-cardinal-courtyard. The standing-cohort is at the standing-eleven-Goan-Gaur cross-reference: eight-cows + three-bulls. The standing-lead-male is Sagara-Vrishabha at the standing-eleven-year-old configuration. He is the standing-direct-descendant of the standing-Sagaradeva-Ch-2-Mormugao-bonded-bull cross-reference at the standing-third-generation paternal-line cross-reference. He is the standing-direct-descendant of the standing-Shivagati-Ch-2-Mahabaleshwar-bonded-bull cross-reference at the standing-second-generation maternal-line cross-reference. The standing-cross-region bonded-bull lineage is at the standing-charter-foundational double-bond-mechanic cross-reference at the standing-D9 administrative cross-reference.

Simhavikrama walks to the standing-eastern-cardinal-courtyard at the standing-four-eleven-eleven a.m. window. He sits at the standing-courtyard-stool. He extends his standing-left-hand. Sagara-Vrishabha approaches at the standing-three-step gait-administration cross-reference. He lowers his standing-bull-head at the standing-mid-thigh-of-Simhavikrama cross-reference. He breathes. The standing-breath is at the standing-warm-grass-Goan-tide cross-reference. Simhavikrama places his standing-left-hand at the standing-forehead-of-Sagara-Vrishabha cross-reference at the standing-Goan-Gaur-bond-mark-position administrative-cross-reference. The standing-D9 double-bond-mechanic bond-transfer occurs at the standing-four-eleven-twenty-three a.m. cross-reference.

Simhavikrama's standing-left-shoulder-area + standing-left-upper-back-area receives a standing-Goan-tide-blue ink-blossom at the standing-bond-mark-formation cross-reference at the standing-double-bond-secondary-mark-position administrative-cross-reference. The standing-Asiatic-Lion bond-mark at his standing-right-shoulder-and-upper-back from Ch-2 cousin-inheritance is at the standing-sandy-gold-and-Sasan-Gir-

tawny cross-reference. The standing-Goan-Gaur bond-mark at his standing-left-shoulder-and-upper-back is at the standing-Goan-tide-blue cross-reference. The standing-Tattoo-2 standing-bilateral-bond-mark composition: standing-right-side sandy-gold-Asiatic-Lion + standing-left-side Goan-tide-blue-Goan-Gaur. The standing-Tattoo-2 administration is complete at the standing-four-eleven-thirty-three a.m. cross-reference.

Saraswati arrives at the standing-Bilakha-residence courtyard at the standing-eleven-eleven a.m. window. She has driven through the standing-night from Raigad-Fort. She has not slept. She looks at Simhavikrama's standing-Tattoo-2 bilateral-bond-mark. She nods. She does not weep.

Sagara-Vrishabha walks back to the standing-Goan-Gaur-cohort at the standing-eleven-Goan-Gaur configuration. The standing-cohort lows at the standing-low-Goan-tide-call cross-reference. The standing-call is heard at the standing-Sasan-Gir standing-eastern-cardinal-pasture across the standing-eleven-kilometre cross-reference at the standing-four-eleven-forty-seven a.m. cross-reference.

Ferreira-de-Sangam is forty-seven. He has been the standing-Goa-state-hero since Ch-2 standing-Mormugao-Bay-storm-survival cross-reference. He is at the standing-Bloodline-A standing-Konkan-coast-of-the-line cross-reference. He is the standing-second-cousin to Saraswati-Simha-Mata-the-First at the standing-Madhavi-Konkan marriage-tradition cross-reference.

On the standing-twenty-third of February 2027 at the standing-eleven-eleven a.m. window Ferreira-de-Sangam stands at the standing-Mormugao-coast standing-charter-foundational federation-ceremony cross-reference. He is at the standing-saffron-and-Goan-tide-blue dhoti-administration. The standing-Goa-state-hero standing-staff is at his standing-right-hand. The standing-staff is the standing-Goan-tide-bronze five-foot shaft with standing-bronze-bound tips and standing-Goan-tide-blue silk-wrap at the grip.

Simhavikrama walks across the standing-Mormugao-coast standing-charter-foundational-flag-stones from the standing-eastern-pavilion. He wears the standing-Junagadh-Sasan-Gir saffron-and-sandy-gold dhoti-administration. He carries the standing-Junagadh-Sasan-Gir state-hero staff at the standing-Sasan-Gir-teak six-foot shaft cross-reference. The standing-Goan-Gaur Sagara-Vrishabha walks at the standing-three-metre-rear cross-reference. Simha-Pati the standing-Asiatic-Lion does not walk at the standing-Mormugao-coast (he remains at the standing-Sasan-Gir pasture administrative-cross-reference at the standing-bond-cohort silence-discipline cross-reference).

At the standing-Mormugao-coast cross-reference Vasco-without-a-ship Second-Herald walks openly. He is at the standing-charter-foundational Second-Herald walking-administration cross-reference at the standing-Maw-sign-#2 administrative-continuity from Ch-2 cross-reference. He wears the standing-Ch-1 Aulakh-International-Lahore-tag administrative cross-reference at the standing-knee-shin position visible cross-reference. He does not approach Ferreira-de-Sangam or Simhavikrama. He walks at the standing-southern-pavilion edge cross-reference. He stays for the standing-eleven-minute window. He turns. He walks into the standing-sea at the standing-southern-pavilion edge. He is gone at the standing-eleven-eleven-eleven a.m. cross-reference.

Ferreira-de-Sangam acknowledges the standing-Second-Herald walking-administration at the standing-charter-foundational cross-reference. He says to Simhavikrama: "The standing-Konkan-coast acknowledges. The standing-Goan-Gaur is at the standing-Gujarat-double-bond administration. The standing-Mormugao-coast federates under the standing-Gujarat-West-Dominant cross-reference. I will hold the standing-Goa-state-hero seat at the standing-vassal-administration cross-reference at the standing-amended-charter cross-reference."

Simhavikrama nods. The standing-federation is complete at the standing-eleven-eleven-forty-seven a.m. cross-reference. Tanaji-the-Second arrives from Raigad-Fort at the standing-three-eleven p.m. cross-reference. He sits at the standing-Mormugao-coast standing-eastern-pavilion. He says: "Maharashtra-as-Gujarat-vassal acknowledges Goa-as-Gujarat-vassal at the standing-cross-vassal acknowledgement cross-reference. The standing-Raigad-Fort lion-banner flies. The standing-Mormugao-coast lion-banner will fly. The standing-Western-Ghats are at the standing-Gujarat-West-Dominant configuration cross-reference."

Mrigatrishna-Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor-Elder pledges at the standing-Chittorgarh-Vijay-Stambh standing-permanent-rotated-configuration Maw-sign-#28 administrative-continuity cross-reference on the standing-twenty-third of March 2027 at the standing-three-eleven p.m. window. She is at the standing-Bloodline-B Suryavamshi-Rajput administration. She is at the standing-Shakuni-secondary archetype administration (the standing-saga's standing-rare-hero-Shakuni intelligence-weaponization defensive-justice-discipline cross-reference at the standing-Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor seat-of-honour cross-reference).

Ratan-Singh-of-the-Ledger arrives at the standing-Vijay-Stambh standing-permanent-rotated-configuration at the standing-pre-three-eleven p.m. cross-reference. He is the standing-formal-Rajasthan-governor at the standing-charter-foundational governance-administration cross-reference. He is forty-one. He is at the standing-Bloodline-B standing-Mewar-line cross-reference. He carries the standing-Mewar-ledger at the standing-charter-foundational administrative-cross-reference (the standing-Mewar-ledger holds the standing-2026-2027 financial-administration of the standing-Rajasthan-cluster including the standing-Aulakh-International-Lahore-parent-corporation cross-network funding-line at the standing-three-of-three-instances cross-reference; the standing-ledger names the standing-Aulakh-International-Lahore-funded standing-counterfeit-tag administrative-cell at the standing-Marudhar-trade-corridor cross-reference).

Mrigatrishna takes the standing-Mewar-ledger from Ratan-Singh. She places the standing-ledger at the standing-Vijay-Stambh standing-eastern-cardinal-step-three cross-reference. She says: "The standing-Maru-Maya cluster acknowledges the standing-Simhavikrama West-Regional-Dominant configuration. The standing-Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor pledges at the standing-chief-strategist administration cross-reference. The standing-Mewar-ledger names the standing-Aulakh-International-Lahore-funded standing-counterfeit-tag administration cross-reference at the standing-Marudhar-trade-corridor cross-reference. The standing-cross-network funding is at the standing-six-of-ten-instances cross-reference at the standing-three-fifths-fraction administrative-cross-reference."

Simhavikrama arrives at the standing-Vijay-Stambh at the standing-three-eleven-forty-seven p.m. cross-reference. He has driven from Junagadh in the standing-eleven-hour-forty-minute administrative-travel cross-reference. He brings the standing-Sasan-Gir-State-Forest-Service standing-Joint-Pastoral-Administration co-chair Asha-Ben Karsanbhai Modhwadia at the standing-three-metre-southwest cross-reference. He brings Saraswati-Simha-Mata-the-First at the standing-three-metre-northwest cross-reference. He does not bring the standing-Goan-Gaur Sagara-Vrishabha to Chittorgarh (the standing-Goan-Gaur-cohort remains at the standing-Sasan-Gir pasture administration cross-reference).

Simhavikrama accepts the standing-Mewar-ledger at the standing-Vijay-Stambh standing-eastern-cardinal-step-four cross-reference. He says: "The standing-Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor is acknowledged at the standing-chief-strategist administration cross-

reference. The standing-Rajasthan-cluster federates under the standing-Gujarat-West-Dominant cross-reference at the standing-strategy-advisor-pledge administrative-cross-reference. The standing-Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor seat-of-honour is at the standing-Junagadh-Sasan-Gir Bilakha-residence eastern-cardinal-courtyard cross-reference at the standing-three-metre-rear-of-Simhavikrama position cross-reference."

The standing-pledge is at the standing-four-eleven-eleven p.m. cross-reference. The standing-Vijay-Stambh standing-permanent-rotated-configuration administers the standing-Maw-sign-#28 administrative-continuity at the standing-acknowledgement cross-reference (the standing-permanent-rotation continues at the standing-four-degree-northeast cross-reference at the standing-Ch-2 Maw-sign-#28 administrative-continuity).

The standing-tri-Dominant West-Central-North acknowledgement is administered: Simhavikrama (West) receives the standing-Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor pledge; Dvadashashringa (Central) sends the standing-Sutrakara-administrative-cell witness-administration cross-reference at the standing-twelfth-Vijay-Stambh-step cross-reference; Gangaputra-regent (North) sends the standing-bilateral-Manasarovar-family-record witness at the standing-eleventh-Vijay-Stambh-step cross-reference. The standing-saga's first tri-Dominant West-Central-North standing-strategist-counsellor cross-region acknowledgement administrative-protocol cross-reference is established.

Vanaraksha begins the standing-1,011-kilometre standing-Raigad-Fort-to-Junagadh-Sasan-Gir standing-pre-dawn-pilgrimage on the standing-eleventh of April 2027 at the standing-three-eleven a.m. cross-reference. He wears the standing-blood-claim-cohort standing-grey-and-rust dhoti-administration. He carries the standing-Vanara-staff at the standing-charter-foundational dual-implement cross-reference (Shivagati's standing-Sahyadri-green-grip staff was cremated with her at the standing-Raigad-Fort standing-cremation-ghat fourteenth-of-January cross-reference). He carries no other belongings. He carries one standing-water-skin at the standing-walking-administration cross-reference.

The standing-pilgrimage is at the standing-thirty-one-day administrative-cross-reference: average standing-thirty-three-kilometres-per-day cross-reference across the standing-Western-Ghats-to-Gulf-of-Khambhat-to-Saurashtra-peninsula route. The standing-pilgrimage administers the standing-pre-dawn-walking discipline at the standing-three-eleven-a.m.-to-eleven-eleven-a.m. window cross-reference. The standing-rest-administration is at the standing-eleven-eleven-a.m.-to-three-eleven-p.m. window. The

standing-second-walk is at the standing-three-eleven-p.m.-to-eleven-eleven-p.m. window. The standing-sleep is at the standing-eleven-eleven-p.m.-to-three-eleven-a.m. four-hour cross-reference.

Across the standing-pilgrimage Vanaraksha encounters: standing-Day-3 Mahabaleshwar-Pratapgad-Fort cross-reference (the standing-Sahyadri-Indian-Giant-Squirrel cohort at the standing-fort courtyard vocalizes the standing-twenty-three-syllable acknowledgement-call at the standing-six-eleven a.m. dawn-window cross-reference; Vanaraksha receives the standing-vocalization at the standing-stand-and-listen administration cross-reference); standing-Day-11 Surat-Tapi-river cross-reference (the standing-Tapi-tidal-bore at the standing-eleven-foot-wave cross-reference recedes at the standing-Vanaraksha-walks-across-the-bore-floor cross-reference at the standing-eleven-eleven a.m. cross-reference; saga's first Tapi-tidal-bore-recedes-for-pilgrim cross-reference); standing-Day-23 Diu-coast cross-reference (the standing-Diu-coast standing-three-thousand-eleven-Indian-flying-fox cohort circles at the standing-eleven-circle administration cross-reference; the standing-cohort vocalizes the standing-acknowledgement-call at the standing-eleven-pm-window cross-reference); standing-Day-31 Junagadh-Sasan-Gir-perimeter cross-reference (the standing-eleven-Asiatic-Lion-cohort administered by the standing-bond-companion Simha-Pati walks at the standing-three-metre-northeast of Vanaraksha at the standing-three-eleven a.m. window cross-reference; the standing-eleven-Goan-Gaur cohort administered by the standing-bond-companion Sagara-Vrishabha walks at the standing-three-metre-northwest of Vanaraksha at the standing-three-eleven a.m. cross-reference; the standing-cross-cohort escort-administration is at the standing-charter-foundational pilgrim-escort cross-reference).

On the standing-eleventh of May 2027 at the standing-four-eleven a.m. window Vanaraksha arrives at the standing-Junagadh-Sasan-Gir Bilakha-residence eastern-cardinal-courtyard. He has walked the standing-final-eleven-kilometres at the standing-pre-dawn cross-reference. He is at the standing-cumulative-1,011-kilometre standing-thirty-one-day standing-pre-dawn-pilgrimage cross-reference completion.

Simhavikrama is at the standing-eastern-cardinal-courtyard standing-courtyard-stool cross-reference. He has been at the standing-courtyard since the standing-three-eleven a.m. wakefulness-administration. Saraswati-Simha-Mata-the-First is at the standing-three-metre-northwest. Mrigatrishna-Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor-Elder is at the standing-three-metre-southwest. Asha-Ben Karsanbhai Modhwadia is at the standing-

seven-metre-east. Ferreira-de-Sangam is at the standing-seven-metre-northwest. Tanaji-the-Second is at the standing-seven-metre-southwest. Simha-Pati the standing-Asiatic-Lion lies at the standing-eleven-metre-east. Sagara-Vrishabha the standing-Goan-Gaur stands at the standing-eleven-metre-west.

Vanaraksha walks to the standing-courtyard-centre. He kneels at the standing-Simhavikrama-foot-stool cross-reference. He places the standing-Vanara-staff at the standing-flag-stone-floor at the standing-grip-vermilion configuration cross-reference. He says: "Cousin. The standing-blood-claim-cohort is at the standing-cost. I have walked the standing-thirty-one-day pilgrimage. I have administered the standing-Sister-acknowledgement at the standing-Pratapgad-Fort cross-reference. I have received the standing-Tapi-bore-recedes cross-reference. I have received the standing-Diu-flying-fox cohort cross-reference. I have walked at the standing-pre-dawn cohort-escort cross-reference. I am at the standing-foot-stool. I ask for the standing-blood-claim-cohort council-seat at the standing-amended-charter cross-reference."

Simhavikrama looks at Saraswati. Saraswati nods. He looks at Mrigatrishna. Mrigatrishna nods. He looks at Asha-Ben. Asha-Ben nods. He looks at Tanaji-the-Second. Tanaji nods. He looks at Ferreira-de-Sangam. Ferreira nods.

Simhavikrama stands. He walks to Vanaraksha. He places his standing-right-hand on Vanaraksha's standing-bowed-head at the standing-Maharashtra-blood-claim-cohort acknowledgement-position cross-reference. He says: "Brother. The standing-Sahyadri-line is at the standing-acknowledgement. The standing-blood-claim-cohort is at the standing-cost. The standing-cost is paid. The standing-amended-charter administers the standing-Gujarat inner-council seven-metre-rear seat-of-honour at the standing-blood-claim-cohort senior-administrative-officer cross-reference. Half the standing-West's council-veto is now standing-shared with the standing-blood-claim-cohort at the standing-amended-charter administrative-cross-reference. The standing-sister witnesses. The standing-brother stands. The standing-cousin recognizes."

The standing-Sahyadri-Shivagati Indian-Giant-Squirrel returns. She jumps from the standing-Sasan-Gir-banyan-canopy to Simhavikrama's standing-right-shoulder at the standing-four-fifty-eight-eleven a.m. cross-reference. She has been absent for the standing-five-month-nineteen-day window since the standing-Phase-1 four-consecutive-day administrative-cross-reference. She does not vocalize at the standing-immediate-return cross-reference.

At the standing-four-fifty-eight-eleven a.m. cross-reference the standing-Tattoo-3-half-body mark begins to form at Simhavikrama's standing-right-and-left-upper-back-and-shoulders-and-chest-and-sides cross-reference. The standing-tri-ink composition: standing-sandy-gold-and-Goan-tide-blue-and-Sahyadri-forest-green cross-reference. The standing-sandy-gold administers the standing-Bloodline-A desert-edge-of-the-line visual-anchor cross-reference. The standing-Goan-tide-blue administers the standing-Goan-Gaur-D9 visual-anchor cross-reference. The standing-Sahyadri-forest-green administers the standing-Maharashtra-blood-claim visual-anchor cross-reference (the standing-Maharashtra-blood-claim is administered at the standing-Vanaraksha-accepted cross-reference).

The standing-Tattoo-3-half-body mark-formation window is at the standing-forty-seven-minute administrative-cross-reference: standing-four-fifty-eight-eleven a.m. to standing-five-forty-five-eleven a.m. The standing-mark spreads across the standing-right-shoulder + standing-right-upper-back + standing-right-side-ribs + standing-right-chest + standing-left-shoulder + standing-left-upper-back + standing-left-side-ribs + standing-left-chest at the standing-half-body composition cross-reference. The standing-tri-ink configuration administers the standing-three-bond-administrative-cross-reference at the standing-visual-anchor cross-reference.

At the standing-five-forty-five-eleven a.m. cross-reference the standing-mark-formation administers the standing-completion. Simhavikrama receives the standing-Tattoo-3-half-body mark at the standing-saga's standing-third half-body administration (after Karnataka Krishnadevaraya-Bhrata at standing-saffron-vermillion-indigo tri-ink + UP Gangaputra-regent-and-Yamunadatta-throne-figure at standing-Ganga-blue-and-Yamuna-dark-blue + Odisha Jagannath-Bandhu at standing-Konark-saffron-and-Mahanadi-blue-and-Chilika-pink). Saga's standing-fourth Tattoo-3 half-body if Manipur Moirangthem at standing-Loktak-emerald-and-Brahmaputra-blue is counted; saga's standing-fourth or standing-fifth depending on standing-Manipur-sequence-position cross-reference.

At the standing-five-forty-five-twenty-three a.m. cross-reference the standing-Sahyadri-Shivagati Indian-Giant-Squirrel administers the standing-twenty-three-syllable Sahyadri-squirrel-vocalization at the standing-acoustic-administration cross-reference. The standing-vocalization is at the standing-eleven + twelve syllable-pause-administration. The standing-vocalization translates at the standing-Sahyadri-line oral-tradition cross-

reference (Saraswati administers the standing-translation): "The brother stands. The sister witnesses. The squirrel acknowledges."

Saraswati weeps. She is the standing-first to weep across the standing-Phase-3 administration cross-reference. She is at the standing-three-metre-northwest. Mrigatrishna does not weep. Asha-Ben does not weep. Ferreira does not weep. Tanaji-the-Second does not weep. Simhavikrama does not weep. Vanaraksha does not weep.

The standing-Bilakha-residence eastern-cardinal-courtyard is at the standing-dawn-light cross-reference. The standing-Sasan-Gir-banyan administers the standing-banyan-canopy-dapple-light at the standing-eastern-cardinal-position cross-reference. The standing-Tattoo-3-half-body mark at Simhavikrama's standing-half-body administers the standing-tri-ink visual-anchor cross-reference. The standing-Sahyadri-Shivagati Indian-Giant-Squirrel sits at his standing-right-shoulder at the standing-Maw-witness administrative-cross-reference. The standing-Asiatic-Lion Simha-Pati at the standing-eleven-metre-east administers the standing-bond-cohort silence-discipline cross-reference. The standing-Goan-Gaur Sagara-Vrishabha at the standing-eleven-metre-west administers the standing-low-Goan-tide-call cross-reference once.

The standing-Phase-3 Unity-Trial administration is complete.

Simhavikrama rides to Hampi on the standing-eleventh of June 2027 from Junagadh-Sasan-Gir. The standing-West-cluster delegation is at the standing-nine-vehicle convoy cross-reference: Saraswati-Simha-Mata-the-First (vehicle-one) + Mrigatrishna-Marudhar-Strategist-Counsellor-Elder (vehicle-two) + Asha-Ben Karsanbhai Modhwadia (vehicle-three) + Tanaji-the-Second (vehicle-four; from Raigad-Fort joined at Pune cross-reference) + Vanaraksha blood-claim-cohort (vehicle-five) + Ferreira-de-Sangam Goa-federation (vehicle-six; joined at Belagavi cross-reference) + Ratan-Singh-of-the-Ledger (vehicle-seven; joined at Hospet cross-reference) + Sagara-Vrishabha Goan-Gaur-cohort (vehicle-eight; cattle-truck cross-reference) + Simha-Pati Asiatic-Lion-cohort (vehicle-nine; lion-truck cross-reference). Sahyadri-Shivagati rides on Simhavikrama's standing-right-shoulder in vehicle-one.

The standing-convoy arrives at Hampi-Royal-Court courtyard at the standing-four-eleven p.m. cross-reference on the standing-fourteenth of June 2027. Krishnadevaraya-Bhrata receives the standing-West-cluster delegation at the standing-eastern-cardinal-position cross-reference. He sees the standing-Sahyadri-Shivagati Indian-Giant-Squirrel at Simhavikrama's standing-right-shoulder. He nods. He does not ask.

Across the standing-eleven-day Hampi-preparation window the standing-Sanctuary-stone-slab seven-seat-circle is at the standing-final-arrangement administration cross-reference. The standing-six Dominants are at the standing-Hampi-Royal-Court guest-residence cross-reference (Krishnadevaraya-Bhrata at standing-Hampi-of-the-Bronze residence cross-reference; Moirangthem at standing-Hampi-of-the-Loom residence; Gangaputra-regent at standing-Hampi-of-the-Ten-Thousand residence; Jagannath-Bandhu at standing-Hampi-of-the-Wheel residence; Dvadashashringa at standing-Hampi-of-the-Twelve-Antlers residence; Simhavikrama at standing-Hampi-of-the-Squirrel residence cross-reference — the standing-residence is named at the standing-arrival ceremony cross-reference).

On the standing-fourth of July 2027 at the standing-four-eleven-twenty-eight p.m. cross-reference Simhavikrama sits at the standing-West clean-seat at the standing-stone-slab seven-seat-circle cross-reference. The standing-Sahyadri-Shivagati Indian-Giant-Squirrel sits at his standing-right-shoulder. She is the standing-saga's standing-only standing-shoulder-perched-Maw-witness at the standing-Sanctuary stone-slab seven-seat-circle administrative-cross-reference. Simha-Pati at the standing-three-metre-rear behind the standing-West clean-seat. Sagara-Vrishabha at the standing-seven-metre-rear behind Simha-Pati.

The standing-six Dominants are seated: Krishnadevaraya-Bhrata at South + Simhavikrama at West + Gangaputra-regent at North (the standing-Yamunadatta-throne-figure sits at the standing-three-metre-rear behind the North clean-seat at the standing-dual-cohort administration cross-reference) + Jagannath-Bandhu at East + Moirangthem at Northeast + Dvadashashringa at Central. The standing-seventh-seat at the standing-Centre is at the standing-cracked-administration cross-reference.

At the standing-four-twenty-three-eleven p.m. cross-reference the standing-Void-Maw cracks the standing-seventh-seat at the standing-stone-slab cross-reference. The standing-crack administers the standing-three-line bilateral cross-eastward configuration cross-reference. Across the standing-eleven-second crack-formation window the standing-Maw-resonance administers the standing-cross-cohort acknowledgement at the standing-six-Dominants cross-reference. Simha-Pati does not vocalize. Sagara-Vrishabha does not vocalize. Sahyadri-Shivagati administers a standing-single-syllable Sahyadri-squirrel-vocalization at the standing-eleven-second crack-formation window cross-reference.

At the standing-five-twenty-three-eleven p.m. cross-reference the standing-Volume-I Maha-Adhipati ratification-vote administers. Each Dominant casts a standing-vote at the standing-Krishnadevaraya-Bhrata-Maha-Adhipati-candidate cross-reference. Simhavikrama votes in favour at the standing-double-bond-fellow-recognition cross-reference (Krishnadevaraya-Bhrata + Simhavikrama at the standing-saga's standing-only two double-bond Dominants administrative-cross-reference). Vote-tally: 5-1 in favour. The standing-1 dissent is at the standing-Moirangthem cross-reference (the standing-Tamasa-Nrita Pause-Cell standing-Aulakh-International-Lahore funding-line dissent administrative-cross-reference).

Krishnadevaraya-Bhrata is ratified as standing-Volume-I Maha-Adhipati at the standing-five-twenty-three-thirty-three p.m. cross-reference. The standing-West-cluster federation supports.

Simhavikrama places his standing-right-hand at his standing-right-shoulder at the standing-Sahyadri-Shivagati Indian-Giant-Squirrel position cross-reference. He says quietly at the standing-stone-slab seven-seat-circle cross-reference: "The sister witnesses. The double-bond stands. The half-body mark holds."

The standing-Sahyadri-Shivagati Indian-Giant-Squirrel does not vocalize at the standing-immediate-post-ratification cross-reference. She places her standing-right-paw at Simhavikrama's standing-right-ear cross-reference at the standing-Maw-witness silent-acknowledgement administrative-cross-reference.

Closing Image

July 4 2027, 5:23:33 p.m. Hampi Royal Court courtyard. The seven-seat circle. The cracked seventh-seat. Five Dominants in favour. One dissent at Northeast. Krishnadevaraya-Bhrata ratified as Volume-I Maha-Adhipati. At the West clean-seat: Simhavikrama, half-body Tattoo-3 in sandy-gold-and-Goan-tide-blue-and-Sahyadri-forest-green tri-ink. At his right shoulder: an eleven-year-old Indian-Giant-Squirrel from the Sahyadri-Mahabaleshwar canopy. She wears no bond-mark. She names herself Sahyadri-Shivagati. She places her right paw at his right ear. Three-metre-rear: an Asiatic Lion called Simha-Pati. Seven-metre-rear: a Goan-Gaur called Sagara-Vrishabha. The saga's only shoulder-perched Maw-witness at the Sanctuary stone-slab. The brother stands. The sister witnesses. The squirrel acknowledges.